PUBLISHER / CO-DEVELOPMENT PROPOSAL

Order of the General

STALINGRAD 1942

A card-driven hex-and-counter wargame of Stalingrad and Operation Uranus.

Feature-complete Alpha · Windows 10/11 x64

Shihe Zhao (MrZhao) · szhao9906@gmail.com · November 2026



Digital wargames force a bad choice

- **Deep rules, weak interface.** Players fight the UI before the enemy.
- **Card games without a model.** Orders are cards, but terrain, supply and ZOC are decoration.
- **Historical presentation, no decision layer.** A diorama that plays the same way twice.
- **AI that cheats or does nothing.** Neither teaches the rules nor rewards planning.

THE RESULT

Hard to learn.
Easy to solve.
Neither a wargame nor a card game.

Order of the General starts from the opposite direction.

A wargame first. Card-driven second.

- **Hexes and counters.** ZOC, LOS, stacking, supply, morale, fieldworks.
- **Orders are a hand.** Movement, attack and special cards — not a menu.
- **Tempo is the design.** You have the plan; you do not have the actions to do everything.
- **The AI plays the same game.** Same decks, same rules, no hand-reading.



Marinovka and the Chir, 23 November 1942. Selected Soviet tank brigade; counter panel, hand, objectives, victory conditions.

CORE LOOP

One phase, six decisions

01

Deal

4 normal + 3 special cards

02

Command

Spend CP and action points

03

Act

Move, fire, suppress, assault

04

Resolve

Morale, supply, fieldworks, casualties

05

React

End the phase; the AI acts

06

Judge

Objectives, losses, next round

Each phase deals a fresh hand; specials carry from movement into attack. The round ends on objectives, not on a kill count.

Ground has memory



Terrain tooltip: water is impassable to foot and tracked; the river and ferries shape every plan.

- 216 m per hex; company/battalion scale
- ZOC ends movement and blocks ZOC-to-ZOC steps
- Line of fire, orchards, urban cover
- Stacking by echelon
- Supply traces and encirclement
- Fieldworks and artillery sheaves

A hand, not a menu

- **Movement deck.** Advance, Strategic Move, Infiltration, Recon, Resupply, Refit.
- **Attack deck.** Attack, Assault, Fire, Direct Fire, Suppress, Defend, Entrench.
- **Special deck.** Reinforcements, events, high command; carried across the round.
- **Prepared Manoeuvre.** Attack-phase move at 0.8× MP; reach shown before commitment.
- **Infiltration.** 0.75× MP, ignores ZOC; spend all remaining AP.



Axis hand, 26 November 1942: two Strategic Move cards, Advance, Refit; Romanian 1st Tank Regiment selected.

AI that plays the same game

- **Legal-action planner.** Not scripted triggers; it scores what is actually legal.
- **Prep before assault.** Artillery, suppression, combined arms, observed fire.
- **Armour behaves like armour.** Keeps range against infantry; closes after suppression.
- **Anti-tank guns.** Hold key ground and cover armour approaches.
- **Five levels.** Easy, Normal, Hard, Extreme, Astra — same rules, different planning depth.

8
playable boards

106
unit templates

51
card definitions

400
self-play games

No hand-reading. No hidden-order reading.

Eight boards, one ruleset





CITY

Mamayev Kurgan
Balka / factories
City centre
Lower town

URANUS

Kletskaya
Raspopinskaya
Kalach / Don
Marinovka / Chir

All eight share the same rules, decks, AI and UI. Content is authored — not a separate engine per battle.

Stalingrad city: four street-by-street boards. Operation Uranus: four encirclement boards.

STATUS

Feature-complete alpha

PLAYABLE TODAY

- Card / CP / action-point loop
- Complete combat resolution
- AI turns, five levels
- Save / load, hot-seat, LAN
- English UI
- Eight boards

PRODUCTION FINISH

- Guided tutorial slice
- Audio / music / SFX
- Animation / VFX
- Historical-photo clearance
- QA + localization QA
- Steam integration

The engine and content are built. The remaining work is production finish, not another prototype.

The tutorial is the demo



Kletskaya bridgehead: the opening situation a new player would meet in the guided tutorial.

- 10–15 minute guided tutorial; one map
- Select unit and card → ZOC → attack preview
- Artillery minimum / maximum range
- Suppression → assault → supply / refit
- End turn → AI → objective check
- Same build is the publisher demo

PRODUCTION

Six-to-eight months to a commercial beta

UI/UX + tutorial	Guided slice, onboarding, readability
Photo rights	Clearance ledger, licensed or replaced images
Audio	Music, ambience, UI and combat SFX
Animation / VFX	Movement, fire, suppression, artillery, cards
QA	Windows, saves, LAN, localization, regression
Localization	English LQA; additional languages optional
Steam	Steamworks, achievements, cloud saves, depot

THE ASK

Development advance or co-development funding.

Open to publisher-recommended partners or our contracted team.

WHY THIS PROJECT

We are not asking for money to build a prototype.

We are asking for a partner to finish a working wargame.

- Rules engine and AI already built and tested
- Eight boards already content-complete
- Production gap scoped; photo rights audit underway

szhao9906@gmail.com · private build link supplied separately · November 2026